

People and society

Speaking Part 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

People come in all shapes and sizes, and each person has their own unique character traits that make them who they are. Some people are outgoing and extroverted, while others are more introverted and reserved. Some are leaders, while others prefer to follow. Some are analytical, while others are more creative. One common character trait is being ambitious, driven and focused, and not easily discouraged by obstacles. Another trait is being compassionate, empathetic and kind, always putting others before themselves. They have a strong desire to help others and make a positive impact on the world. On the other hand, some people may be impulsive, meaning they act on impulse without thinking about the consequences of their actions. The study of character traits began as early as the 18th century but it was only established as a field of research with the publication of Gordon Allport's "Personality: A Psychological Interpretation" in 1937.

Speaking Part 2. Task 1

Study the advertisement.

Meetings for everyone!



You are considering attending a psychological meeting and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. location;
2. number of members;
3. minimum age;
4. membership fee.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. Where is the psychological meeting located?
2. How many members take part in the meetings?
3. What's the minimum age to take part in the meeting?
4. Is there any membership fee if I want to attend one meeting?

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement.

A new book store now in your area!



You are considering going to the new book store and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. opening hours;
2. kinds of books sold;
3. electronic books;
4. reading club.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Look at the following questions asked by a student. Will they all be approved?

Student's answers:

1. When does your new book store open?
2. What kinds of books sold?
3. Are electronic books available in your book store?
4. Is reading club in your store?

Speaking Part 3. Task 1

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions. Give full answers to the questions (2–3 sentences). Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's Teenagers Round the World Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss friendship. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: What do we need friends for? Is it important to have a best friend? Why?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What do you prefer: having many friends or having a few good friends? Why?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Can your family members be your friends? What can't you talk about with your family members?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Should friends agree on a lot of things? Why or why not?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What can a true friend do for you? Are there any things you will never do for your friend?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Speaking Part 3. Task 2

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions. Give full answers to the questions (2–3 sentences). Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's Teenagers Round the World Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss your preferences and character. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: What activity brings you joy?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Are you responsible for anyone other than yourself?

Student: _____

Interviewer: If you could change one thing about yourself, what would it be?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Who are the most important people in your life?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do you have any phobias? What are they?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 2:

1. This question is about the time when the book store opens. The question though should be about all working hours. The correct version is 'When is your new book store open?'
2. There is no auxiliary verb in the question. This is a grammar mistake. You should ask 'What kinds of books are sold in your book store?' or 'What kinds of books do you sell in your book store?'
3. This is a good question. It will be approved.
4. There is no subject 'there' in this question. The question is about existence of the club, so you need it. Is there a reading club in your store? Will you run a reading club in your store?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 1:

1. I believe we need friends to share our good and bad moments. It is very important to have a best friend. Such a person can always come and help you if you experience difficulties in life.
2. I prefer having a few good friends. I can meet them quite often, call my friends and visit their birthday parties. I can't imagine myself having lots of friends. What would I do then and how would I manage to give attention to all of them?
3. I believe my family members can be my friends, especially my brother and my sister. I wouldn't talk about my personal relationships with other people with them. For example, I would never discuss my relationship with my boyfriend with them.
4. I don't think friends should agree on a lot of things. Everyone can have their own preferences and choose the things they like. I believe friends should have some mutual interests though.
5. A true friend can always help me when I'm in trouble. For example, they could come to my place when I have problems and talk to me. I believe, I will never lie to anyone if my friends ask me about it. I believe we should always tell the truth to all people.

Suggested answers Speaking Part 3. Task 2:

1. I enjoy going for a walk with my friends. We usually meet in parks and spend time there. I love it.
2. Yes, I have a little brother. I have to feed him sometimes since he cannot eat himself yet. He is only 7 months old.
3. I think I would change my laziness. I guess I'm not very motivated to do things like learning.
4. These are my parents. My mom always gives me good advice. I also have a very good time with my dad.
5. I'm afraid of spiders. Even when I see a very small spider, I can scream. I hope I'll deal with this phobia one day.

Speaking part 4. Task 1

Look at the following sentences from Speaking part 4. What are the requirements of point 4 of the plan?

For me, celebrating the New Year holiday with my parents is the best cultural tradition. It's an opportunity to get together, share news and have a very good time.

I believe that not throwing garbage around is the best way to protect nature. It's also quite beneficial to recycle. I do both of these things and I suppose this is my contribution to our planet.

For me, becoming a teacher is ideal. I'll be able to spend a lot of time with children and help them learn.

Express your opinion. Use the words I think, I believe, I suppose, in my opinion, for me. Explain your point of view (what it means, what it will result in, why you think it's a good idea, why you choose such things...). Remember that the last item of the plan could refer to your preferences in general (you prefer), to your hypothetical preferences (you would prefer), to your childhood (you preferred as a child) or to other people (e.g. your relatives prefer).

Now try the following task:

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Places to live". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two places of living;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of the two places of living;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which place of living presented in the pictures you prefer and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Suggested answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 1:

For me, it's best to live in a city. I love to have access to all the facilities city life can offer and it doesn't take much time to see my friends whenever I want to. If I lived in the country, it wouldn't be that easy.

Speaking part 4. Task 2

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Hobbies for the elderly". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1–2) of the two types of hobbies for the elderly people;
- mention the disadvantages (1–2) of the two types of hobbies for the elderly people;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which type of hobby presented in the pictures your elderly relatives prefer and why.



Read a sample answer on page 68, prepared by an expert. How is it different from yours? Have you addressed all the items of the plan?

Writing an email. Asking questions

Read the following sentences from emails. Make up questions that you could ask.

Today I'm going to visit a new shopping centre in my district.

Ask 3 questions about the shopping centre.

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Ask 3 questions about the visit to the shopping centre.

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Writing an email. Task 2

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Jenny:

From: Jenny@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Entertainment
<i>... All my days including weekends look almost alike. How do you spend your free time? Where do you usually go with your friends? What do your parents think about your friends?</i>
<i>Next week I'm going to the cinema ...</i>

Write an email to Jenny.

In your message:

- answer her questions;
- ask 3 questions about her plan.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Writing an email. Task 3

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Ben:

From: Ben@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Helping siblings
<i>... Yesterday my mum asked me to help my sister do her homework. It is tough, don't you think so? What do you usually do if your parents ask you to help your siblings? Would you like to be an only child in the family, and why?</i>
<i>Oh, guess what! I am going to stay with my cousin in San Francisco for a week ...</i>

Write an email to Ben.

In your message:

- answer his questions;
- **ask 3 questions** about his cousin.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing

Sample answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hi Vera, it's Masha. I wasn't not able to get through, so I decided to leave a voice message. I've found two good pictures for our project "Hobbies for the elderly."

I think these illustrations are eminently suitable because they both show different types of things old people are interested in doing. In the first photo I can see an old woman who is knitting. The second illustration depicts an elderly couple who is hiking in the mountains. There is a noticeable difference between the illustrations. The first type of hobby is quite passive while the second is active.

I also want to tell you about the advantages of the two types of hobbies for the elderly people. Old women usually become experts at knitting and the things they knit look fantastic. It also doesn't require much money to do this kind of hobby. As for hiking, people can keep young by doing this. It's not a strenuous type of activity and it helps keep your muscles strong, so it's especially useful for the old.

On the other hand, there are some disadvantages of doing these things as well. If elderly people knit, they usually do not move for a long time, which leads to pain in their body. Hiking requires wearing heavy backpacks which could also result in pain in old people's backs.

Speaking about my elderly relatives, they like to knit. My grandmothers make intricate patterns on clothes they make and I wear them with pleasure. They say they adore this kind of hobby and they like seeing me and my family wearing the things they made.

That's all. Call me back, please. Bye.

Suggested answers for Writing an email. Asking questions

The shopping centre

Is it big?

How many floors are there?

What are the opening hours?

Is the shopping centre very crowded?

The visit to the shopping centre:

What time are you going there?

How much time are you going to spend there?

What shops are you going to visit?

Do you want to buy anything?

Sample answer for Writing an email. Task 2

Hi Jenny,

Thanks for your message. I'm so excited whenever I get a line from you!

It's a pity your days are so monotonous. I usually hang out with my friends when I have free time. We go to the cinema or walk in parks. My parents like my friends a lot. They are all from nice families and my parents made friends with their parents many years ago.

Speaking about going to the cinema. I think it's a nice plan. What film are you going to watch? Are you going alone or with friends? Have you bought the tickets yet?

Hope to hear from you soon!

Best wishes,

Sasha

121 words

Sample answer for Writing an email. Task 3:

Dear Ben,

Thanks for your email. I was glad to hear from you again.

It's incredible that you help your sister do your homework. I believe it's tough. Fortunately, my parents almost never ask me to help my siblings but if they do, I help them do their homework. I don't like doing it though. Personally, I wouldn't like to be an only child in my family. I like playing with my brother and my sister and we have lots of fun together.

By the way, it's great that you're going to San Francisco to visit your cousin. Is he\she a boy or a girl? How old is he\she? What is his\her hobby?

I have to go now. Hope to hear from you soon.

All the best,

Masha

128 words

Writing Task 38. Task 1

Imagine that you are doing a project on **who teenagers prefer to spend their time with in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the table below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.

The survey question: Who do you prefer to spend your time with?	
People	Number of respondents (%)
Peers	54
Siblings	20
Parents	18
Grandparents	6
Aunts and uncles	2

Write 200–250 words.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2–3 facts;
- make 1–2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that one can face with personal relationships and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the importance of personal relationships in our lives.

Sample answers for Writing Task 38. Task 1:

We all need to spend time or communicate with various people throughout our lives. I am doing a project on who teenagers prefer to spend their time with in Zetland. I have found a table with some results of a relevant survey.

According to the data, more than half of the youngsters prefer to spend time with peers (54%). One fifth of the respondents choose siblings to do this. Only 2% of the teenagers enjoy their time with aunts and uncles.

Predictably, three times as many of the teenagers choose parents to spend their time with (18%) as those who do it with grandparents (6%). It is logical as parents are usually closer to teenagers, while grandparents might be old and uninteresting.

Although personal relationships bring a lot of pleasure to people's lives, there are problems one can face. One of the main ones is lack of trust. The best solution is to be consistent – doing what you have said you were going to do and be where you have promised.

In conclusion, I believe that personal relationships play a really significant role in our lives. They help us feel secure and confident because we know that our nearest and dearest will always be there for us.

205 words

Real-life Task 38

Quick questionnaire

Follow the QR-code link or the link below. Answer the question about the birthday present you would like to receive and see the results of other students.

Take a picture of the results and write your data description. Compare two figures and give a comment. Since it's a real-life opinion poll, the results change all the time, so you can do the task again in a while. Keep in mind that the respondents are Russian teenagers.

Address the following:

- outline a problem that can arise with birthday presents and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on how to choose birthday presents for your friends.

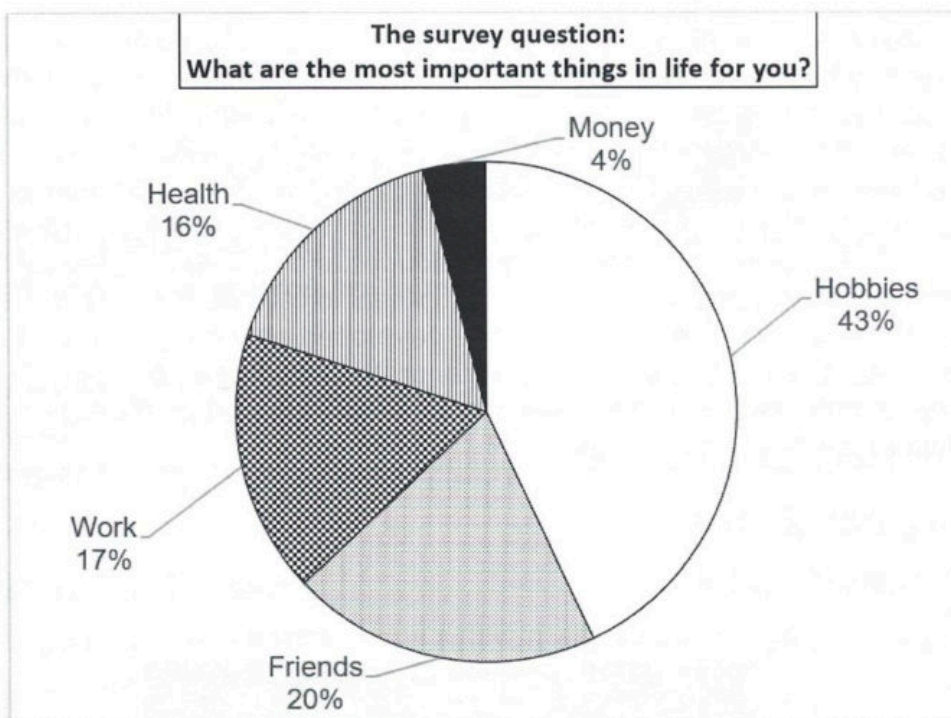


<https://forms.gle/3DfdSzxupgKKt9hu9>

Writing Task 38. Task 2 (Sample answer on page 174)

Imagine that you are doing a project on **the most important things in life in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the pie chart below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.



Write 200–250 words.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2–3 facts;
- make 1–2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that one can face choosing priorities and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the role of choosing priorities in our lives.